

The Doctor Who Wears Many Hats

When medicine meets education, the result can be transformational. Few exemplify this better than Dr. Lasya Thambidurai, who has blended her expertise as a radiologist with her acumen as an academic administrator. Today, she stands tall as a healthcare innovator, an institution builder, and one of the most dynamic women leaders of her generation.

For Dr. Lasya, leadership is not about choosing one path over another—it's about building bridges. Bridges between healthcare and education. Between technology and humanity. And ultimately, between privilege and accessibility. Her journey demonstrates how a single leader can shape not just institutions, but also the communities they serve.

From Harvard to Hosur

Dr. Lasya's credentials span continents. With a Fellowship of the Royal College of Radiologists (FRCR) and advanced training at Harvard University, Boston, she brings global expertise to her work in India. Her clinical practice—covering CT scans, MRIs, ultrasounds, and X-rays—has earned her immense respect within the medical fraternity.

But she never saw herself confined to the diagnostic room. "Medicine gives you the power to heal," she says, "but education gives you the power to transform lives." With this vision, she stepped beyond pure clinical work to take on roles that allowed her to build systems, design learning ecosystems, and contribute to the holistic development of society.

Steering with Vision

As Trustee of St. Peter's and Adhiyamaan Group of Institutions, Dr. Lasya has been instrumental in redefining education for thousands of students across South India. The group runs universities, colleges, and schools in Chennai, Hosur, Krishnagiri, Coimbatore, Bangalore, and Faridabad, creating a wide-reaching impact on learners from diverse socio-economic backgrounds.

Her leadership philosophy is simple yet profound: education must be rooted in empathy and relevance. At

her institutions, this approach has transformed campuses into hubs where academics meet real-world applications. She emphasizes research, innovation, and industry linkages, ensuring that students graduate not just with degrees, but with the confidence to tackle real challenges. By pushing boundaries in curriculum design, technology adoption, and holistic student well-being, she has created a culture where learners are encouraged to question, create, and lead.

Taking Healthcare to the Last Mile

Perhaps the most compelling part of Dr. Lasya's journey is her commitment to social impact. Recognizing that access to healthcare remains one of India's biggest challenges, she has spearheaded mobile healthcare camps, preventive care drives, and free consultation programs across rural areas.

From teaching hygiene and nutrition in schools to organizing large-scale health camps for women, children, and the elderly, her initiatives have touched thousands of lives. Collaborations with government agencies, NGOs, and local panchayats have amplified this reach, ensuring that healthcare doesn't remain an urban privilege but becomes a rural reality as well.

For her, healthcare and education are not separate silos—they are two sides of the same coin. "You can't build a healthy nation without education, and you can't sustain education without healthcare," she often emphasizes. This philosophy drives her integrated approach to community development.

Policy Shaper, Industry Voice

Beyond her role as an administrator, Dr. Lasya plays an active part in shaping policy and industry dialogue. She serves on the Healthcare and Higher Education Panels of the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), Tamil Nadu, and contributes actively to Young Indians (YI) and the Indian Women Network (IWN).

Her interventions frequently highlight the dual challenge India faces—expanding infrastructure while nurturing empathetic professionals. Whether advocating for better rural health systems or pushing for curriculum reforms in

higher education, she is known for bringing both clarity and compassion to policy conversations.

Her voice carries weight because it is rooted in practice, not theory. With one foot in the medical world and the other in academia, she represents a rare perspective—one that understands both the urgency of immediate care and the necessity of long-term systemic change.

Bridging Two Worlds

What makes Dr. Lasya's journey unique is her ability to connect the dots between healthcare and academia. While many choose to specialize narrowly, she has chosen to broaden her impact. Her clinical expertise informs her educational vision, and her educational initiatives strengthen her healthcare mission.

This integrated approach has not only set her apart as a leader but has also created a model for the future. It's a model where medical insights fuel innovation in education, and where academic institutions double up as hubs for healthcare awareness and outreach.

"Leadership is about empowering communities—through knowledge, care, and opportunity," she says. "At SPIHER, our mission is to create not just graduates, but responsible citizens and empathetic leaders."

A Visionary to Watch

In celebrating **Dr. Lasya Thambidurai** as part of the BT500 special issue, Business Today isn't just recognizing professional success—it is celebrating a new kind of leadership. A leadership that transcends silos, redefines impact, and prioritizes community empowerment.

Her story is more than a personal achievement—it is a blueprint for the future of education and healthcare in India. At a time when both sectors face rapid transformation, leaders like Dr. Lasya show us that the best way forward is not just with skill, but with vision, empathy, and courage.

For communities across Tamil Nadu and beyond, her work is already changing lives. For the country, she represents a generation of women leaders who are breaking barriers, rewriting narratives, and building futures.